PDF forms are not compatible with the Google Chrome PDF viewer plug-in. Chrome users should save the form, then reopen and complete with Adobe reader.

EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

My interest in this topic stems from my own experience with mental blocks and lost move syndrome (LMS) in diving. I could never understand my issues or overcome them but have kept an interest for what initially caused them. I first decided to research "lost move syndrome" in acrobatic sports but there was a lack of studies in that area. Instead, I found studies focusing on a similar movement disorder called "Yips", most common in ball sports. I decided to narrow my RQ to what psychosocial factors may be cause Yips as there seemed to be most research there. Although I made good progress, I felt I had no personal engagement with these sports. I decided to research psychological theories of self-efficacy in acrobatic sports and discovered there is viable empirical research.

I began my research by trying to find enough studies which were appropriate for my topic and then narrowing them down to eight studies that directly address the specific RQ. I found that the most useful source to do this was Google Scholar and I learned how to use this by consulting the librarian. Moving forwards, I went through each of the studies to decide how they will fit together as a strategy to answer my RQ. The biggest challenge I faced was understanding the academic writing style of the studies and specifically the statistics. The results were presented in numbers that were unfamiliar to me as I do not read many original published papers in my psychology class. To extend my understanding of statistics, I consulted Maths teachers.

I am satisfied with my final draft. I believe that I have improved my evaluation skills which will support me in future assignments for all my subjects, especially psychology. I have become a more independent researcher as I better understand how to utilise resources to find reliable academic research. I realize that if I had asked for assistance from the librarian and math teachers sooner, I would have been more efficient in my research.

The most significant obstacle I faced in the writing process was the word count. When editing my final draft, I focused on questioning the relevance of small details and evaluations in relation to the arguments I made. Furthermore, I had issues linking the studies. I was forced to go through each of the original research papers again and make mini conclusions for each so I could link them by the strength of the evidence and how they each contributed to each other.

If I were to do this again, I would spend more time on the research process, making more structured and thorough notes of the multiple research papers to assist in deciding what evidence to prioritise to support my argument.

456 words

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